Directions: Read the following passage and then answer the questions.

Living Better, Thanks to Inventions!

Inventions improve people's lives in many ways. People use inventions every day, but they never pause to consider who made them or how they were made. Life would be quite different without the many inventions we have come to rely on.

Automobiles

Automobiles were invented to be a method of transportation over land that did not require the labor of animals. The invention of the automobile changed the landscape and the economy of the nation. This invention led to improved roads. They were transformed from muddy gravel paths into paved highways. Automobiles led to the development of suburbs. People could work in the cities but live away from the noise and crowds of urban life. They also helped people interact with each other by making it easier for them to get together. People could drive to their jobs and their friends' and relatives' homes. The distance between places seemed to contract with the improvement of roads and the arrival of the automobile.

Wheelchairs

Other inventions help fewer people, but they are no less important. The wheelchair, for example, assists people who cannot walk because of their physical condition. A wheelchair is just that—a chair with wheels. Many of them also have motors for independence and greater mobility. All wheelchairs are the same in one way: they help the injured and the physically challenged to get around. They also help friends, family, and others take care of them. People of all ages and different abilities use wheelchairs. Sometimes the need is only temporary.

Telephones



The next time someone gets in touch with you with a message through your telephone, express your thanks to Alexander Graham Bell. He was the man who invented this device. Bell first tested his machine on March 10, 1876. It quickly became popular. His invention opened up a whole new way of communicating. It allowed people to communicate over distances almost instantaneously. Before telephones, most people communicated by writing and by sending letters through the mail. If you can consider such a thing, contemplate what life would be like without telephones.

Computers



Today, computers perform many tasks that only telephones could once do. Much of the work of transmitting phone calls, and thousands of other tasks, is done by computers. Computers are everywhere in the world, and countries could not function without them. We depend upon them to perform many necessary tasks. If computers suddenly shut down, businesses, digital banking and shopping, and travel by airplane and car would halt. Most people would be without energy and communication. Lights would go out, and things could get out of control.

Photography

An invention that has changed our way of seeing ourselves and the world around us is photography. Early photographs captured images of people and events in history. In traditional photography, the light leaves an impression on surfaces coated with chemicals. People used to paint and draw pictures to record people and events in history. Photographs allow us to observe what was there, rather than an artist's interpretation in pencil, paint, or ink. Today, we take digital photographs to record the events of our daily lives, as well as the extraordinary events that we witness.

Taking It Forward

Many inventions have been combined to make life easier. Cell phones have built in cameras so people can take photographs on the go. People can now share those photographs with friends and family right away using telephones and computers. People can use their computers to make video telephone calls. They can talk with friends, family, and coworkers around the world as if they were sitting across the table from them. Without the invention of the photograph, telephone, or computer, these tasks would not be possible. Because these inventions are so familiar to us and we use them every day, they might seem simple. Actually, they are not simple at all, but they have simplified and improved our lives.